

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 5 3 2

♥ 7 3

♦ Q J 10

♣ 9 4

♠ K 6

♥ 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 7 3



♠ 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ J 10 8 6 2

♠ A J 9 4

♥ A K Q J 10

♦ A

♣ A K 5

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|------|-------|------|-------|

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

overruff any of North's trumps.

[showcards N:S6]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦Q, you signaled with the ♦8 and South won the ♦A.

South then played low to dummy's ♠K, and led dummy's ♠6. Your decision is not whether to play high or low, but whether to ruff or not, which amounts to the same thing.

Do not ruff.

Even though South holds the ♠A, if you ruff now he will just put on a small ♠ and you will be ruffing a loser. Instead discard a ♦.

South will win the ♠A, but will not be able to ruff any ♠ losers in dummy because your trumps can

Suppose you had ruffed the ♠. South would have played his ♠9, leaving himself with ♠ A J. He would then get the lead and pull your two remaining trumps. That would leave one trump in dummy to ruff his ♠J, his only remaining loser.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 2  
 ♥ Q 3  
 ♦ Q J 10 6  
 ♣ K Q J 8

♠ J 6 3

♥ A K 10 9 8

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 9 4



♠ A 10 7 4  
 ♥ J 6 5 2  
 ♦ 9 5 4  
 ♣ 5 3

♠ K 8 5

♥ 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ A 7 6 2

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1 ♦          |
| Pass         | 1 ♥          | Pass        | 1NT          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 1NT by South |              |             |              |
| 2 ♥ s.       |              |             |              |

[showcards S:H4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣K and continue with the ♣J then ♣Q, taken by South's ♣A. To trick 4 South plays the ♥4. What do you play?

Play the ♥Q.

To see why you should play the ♥Q, just visualize the result if you play low. South will finesse with dummy's ♥8. If East wins his ♥J on this trick there will be 4 good ♥ tricks in dummy. If East withholds his ♥J then Declarer will have 3 ♥ winners.

Now visualize the result of playing the ♥Q. Whether South takes this trick or not he cannot win more than

**Board 5**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ 9 7 6  
♥ 10 9 8 7  
♦ J 9 6 3  
♣ 9 5

♠ K Q 5  
♥ A 6 3  
♦ A 8 2  
♣ A J 4 3



♠ 10 8 4 3  
♥ J 5 2  
♦ 10 4  
♣ K 10 8 6

♠ A J 2  
♥ K Q 4  
♦ K Q 7 5  
♣ Q 7 2

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1NT          |
| Pass         | 6NT          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 6NT by South |              |             |              |